Landmarks & Roles

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Imagine trying to navigate a city with no street signs, where every building looks the same. That is what a website feels like to a screen reader user without Landmarks and Roles.

- Landmarks: These are like zones on a map. They tell the user 'This is the Navigation' or 'This is the Main Content'
- Roles: These are like name tags. They tell the user exactly what an item is

How to support it

The best way is to use semantic HTML (standard HTML tags). When you use the right tag, the landmark or role is added for you automatically.

- Landmarks: Use `<nav>` for menus and `<main>` for your main content
- Roles: Use `<button>` for buttons and `<a>` for links

You can use code to force a plain box (`<div>`) to act like a `<button>`, but it's risky and takes much more work.

Useful Links

CSS Tricks - Why, How, and When to Use Semantic HTML and ARIA

HTML Semantics and Accessibility Cheat Sheet

How to Improve Web Accessibility with Landmarks